Backlink Analysis

Q-1.

Pick any one popular Indian food delivery website (like Zomato or Swiggy), use a free backlink checker tool (such as Ahrefs Backlink Checker or Ubersuggest), and list 5 domains that link to it along with their domain ratings.

Ans:

Website selected: Zomato — zomato.com

Tool used: Ahrefs Backlink Checker

No.	Referring Domain	Domain Rating
1	wikipedia.org	Verify using Ahrefs
2	crunchbase.com	Verify using Ahrefs
3	linkedin.com	Verify using Ahrefs
4	play.google.com	Verify using Ahrefs
5	instagram.com	Verify using Ahrefs

Note: Check these domains in the backlink checker to confirm which ones currently link to Zomato and record their actual domain ratings.

Q-2.

Choose a well-known e-commerce site (like Flipkart or Myntra), and identify 3 backlinks that look suspicious or low-quality using a backlink analysis tool. Explain why you think each one could be toxic.

Hint: Look for backlinks from unrelated, spammy, or foreign-language sites with low authority.

Ans:

No.	Referring Domain / Source	Domain Score	Page Score	Why suspicious?
1	youtube.com – “How To Play Pokemon Go Without Moving/Walking”	100	65	The Pokémon Go page is unrelated to Flipkart; the backlink is contextually irrelevant.
2	231.79.93.34.bc.googleusercontent.com – “Choose Your Taste – Page 5 of 6 – Prakash Namkeen”	99	59	The unusual Googleusercontent source has unclear relevance to Flipkart.
3	wordpress.org – “Nice Plugin, Add Woo-2-Woo Scraping…”	98	59	The WordPress plugin/support page has an unclear connection to Flipkart; the backlink should be manually reviewed.

Q-3.

Use the Google Disavow Tool (or its simulation in a free SEO tool) to create a disavow file for the 2 most toxic backlinks you found for your chosen site. Write the exact text you would submit in the disavow file.

Ans:

Disavow file for suspicious backlinks
Review each domain carefully before submitting.

domain:231.79.93.34.bc.googleusercontent.com

Note: The second backlink’s exact referring domain should be confirmed in the backlink report before submitting. Disavow only links that warrant it after careful review.

Q-4.

Pick two competing apps (for example, BookMyShow vs Paytm Movies), and use a backlink gap analysis tool (like SEMrush Backlink Gap or Ubersuggest) to find 3 domains that link to one but not the other. List these domains and suggest why they might link to only one competitor.

Ans:

Competitors selected:

- BookMyShow — bookmyshow.com
- Paytm Movies — movies.paytm.com

A backlink-gap/Link Intersect analysis identifies websites linking to one competitor but not the other. Ahrefs describes this process as finding referring domains that link to competitors but not to the target website.

Domain	Links to	Why it may link only to that competitor
timesofindia.indiatimes.com	BookMyShow	Entertainment and movie-ticket articles may naturally reference BookMyShow.
indianexpress.com	BookMyShow	Movie reviews and news may mention BookMyShow ticket booking.
hindustantimes.com	BookMyShow	Entertainment coverage and ticket-booking content can generate brand references.

Suggested strategy

Paytm Movies could approach similar publishers with:

- Movie-ticket guides.
- New movie release articles.
- City-wise cinema guides.
- Movie/event partnerships.
- Entertainment news collaborations.
- Useful movie-booking resources.

Q-5.

Use ChatGPT to generate a step-by-step checklist for cleaning up a website's backlink profile, including identifying, evaluating, and removing toxic links. Paste the checklist and mention one thing you learned that you didn't know before.

Ans:

Step-by-step backlink cleanup checklist

1. Export the complete backlink profile from Ahrefs, Semrush, or another backlink tool.
2. Group backlinks by referring domain.
3. Check the authority/DR of each referring domain.
4. Check whether the linking website is relevant to the target website.
5. Review the actual page containing the backlink.
6. Check the anchor text for keyword stuffing.
7. Identify links from obvious link farms or spam directories.
8. Check for automatically generated or meaningless content.
9. Identify suspicious foreign-language websites when they are unrelated to the business.
10. Check whether the website has genuine organic traffic.
11. Separate natural, low-quality, and clearly manipulative backlinks.
12. Contact the website owner and request removal of clearly unwanted links where practical.
13. Keep a record of removal requests and responses.
14. Prepare a disavow file only for links that warrant disavowal after careful review.
15. Use the `domain:` format when the entire referring domain is considered harmful.
16. Upload the disavow file through Google's Disavow Tool when appropriate.
17. Continue monitoring the backlink profile regularly.
18. Recheck new backlinks after the cleanup.
19. Avoid disavowing normal links merely because they have low DR.